

Books Every Man Should Read

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 24, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/7C8plPPHQ1U> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter rapid-fires ratings on popular self-help and business books, praising actionable reads, dismissing hype-driven ones, and promoting his own free AI guide for online trainers.

Contents

-  The Secret — Rating & Critique
-  The E-Myth — Rating & Praise
-  The Psychology of Money — Rating & Critique
-  Atomic Habits — Rating & Praise
-  Think and Grow Rich vs. Outwitting the Devil
-  7-Day AI Action Plan for Online Trainers — Brandon's Own Book

The Secret — Rating & Critique [0:00](#)

- **Rating: 0 / 10**
- Core critique: the book gives the impression that positive thinking alone is enough to accomplish goals
 - Brandon acknowledges positive thinking does matter — "the more positive you are, the more likely you are to accomplish your goal"
 - However, the book omits the necessity of taking real, concrete action
 - Because action is left out entirely, he disqualifies it with a zero

The E-Myth — Rating & Praise [0:22](#)

- **Rating: Not given explicitly, but described as "Fantastic book"**
- Particularly valuable for business owners at the stage where they need to start hiring
 - Shows how to set up SOPs (Standard Operating Procedures) for every position in a business
 - Gives employees a road map and guide for how to do their jobs
 - Enables the owner to delegate effectively by systematizing roles

The Psychology of Money — Rating & Critique [0:22](#)

- **Rating: 5 / 10**
- Brandon is less impressed than most readers

- Attributes this partly to already being wealthy when he read it — context shapes perceived value
- Core pushback: "just get to work, bro. You don't need to change your psychology. You just need to get the work."
- Implies the book over-intellectualizes what is ultimately an action problem

Atomic Habits — Rating & Praise 0:43

- **Rating: 8 / 10** — described as "a strong eight"
- Praised for practically teaching:
 - How to change habits in a more positive direction
 - How to identify and eliminate bad habits
 - How to establish and reinforce positive habits

Think and Grow Rich vs. Outwitting the Devil 0:43

- **Think and Grow Rich — Rating: 6 / 10**
 - Written by Napoleon Hill
 - Brandon gives it a 6 primarily because Hill wrote a superior book
- **Outwitting the Devil — Rating: 10 / 10**
 - Also by Napoleon Hill — described as "way better than Think and Grow Rich"
 - Brandon's recommendation: if you liked Think and Grow Rich, read Outwitting the Devil instead

"If you like Think and Grow Rich, you'll love the devil book. That book is a 10."

7-Day AI Action Plan for Online Trainers — Brandon's Own Book 1:04

- **Rating: 11 or 12 out of 10** (his own book, self-rated)
- Claims it is the only book specifically written to help online trainers make money and grow their following using AI
- Core motivation for writing it:
 - Online trainers who are not using AI will get left behind
 - Those who leverage AI to create better content, grow their following, and train clients more effectively will dominate the space
- Three key use cases covered:
 - Creating better content
 - Growing your following
 - Helping train clients
- **How to get a free copy:** comment the word "action" in the comments and Brandon sends it directly to you